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S5 Unit 5 – Food & Drinks

A. Reading & Comprehension

Text: "Tastes of Our Town"

Every weekend, the open market in our town fills the air with the smell of fresh bread and grilled fish. Families come early to buy vegetables—red tomatoes, green peppers, purple onions—and to taste *harira*, a warm soup made with chickpeas and lentils. At lunchtime, small cafés serve plates of roasted chicken with lemon and olives. If you want something quick, street vendors offer sardine sandwiches and cups of mint tea.

In the evening, friends often meet for a shared meal. The table usually includes a large salad, fluffy couscous with vegetables, and a spicy sauce on the side. People eat slowly and talk about their week. On special days, there is *pastilla*: a sweet and savory pie filled with chicken, almonds, and cinnamon, covered in thin pastry and sugar. Visitors are surprised by the mix of tastes—salty, sweet, spicy, and fresh.

Local meals are more than food; they bring people together. When someone has good news, they invite neighbors to eat. When the weather is cold, a hot bowl of soup makes everyone feel at home. In our town, eating is a way to celebrate, to comfort, and to share.

Tasks

1. **Gist:** In one sentence, what is the main idea of the text?
2. **Detail (choose the correct answer):**
   a. People buy vegetables at the (market / supermarket / bakery).
   b. For a quick snack, vendors sell (pastilla / sardine sandwiches / grilled lamb).
   c. *Pastilla* tastes (only sweet / sweet and savory / only spicy).
3. **True/False/Not Given:**
   a. People eat quickly in the evening.
   b. Soup is popular in cold weather.
   c. Visitors don't like the food.
4. **Short Answer:**
   a. Name two ingredients in *harira*.

   b. What do people do when they have good news?

5. **Vocabulary in context:** Find words in the text that mean:
   a. "cooked in an oven with dry heat" (adj.)
   b. "thin sheets of pastry" (noun)
   c. "a hot drink made with leaves and water" (noun)

B. Vocabulary – Food Items, Meals, Restaurant Phrases

1. **Food groups (categorize):** Place the words in the correct group.
   Words: bread, oranges, chicken, couscous, tomatoes, yogurt, sardines, rice, almonds, onions

- **Grains/Carbs:** _____
- **Fruit/Vegetables:** _____

- **Protein/Dairy:** _____

2. **Meal collocations (match):**
    1. a bowl of ___ a) tea
    2. a glass of ___ b) soup
    3. a cup of ___ c) bread
    4. a slice of ___ d) water
3. **Restaurant phrases (gap-fill):**
   Complete with: *Could I…, I'd like…, the bill, still or sparkling, anything else*
   a. ___ a table for two, please?
   b. ___ the chicken with lemon, please.
   c. Would you like water—___?
   d. That's all, thanks. ___?
   e. ___, please.

C. Grammar Focus: Countable/Uncountable Nouns + some/any

Explanation:

1) Countable nouns

- You can count them: **1 tomato, 2 tomatoes**.
- Forms: **singular** (tomato) and **plural** (tomatoes).
- Determiners you can use:
    - **a/an** with singular: *a tomato, an onion*
    - **numbers**: *two tomatoes, three eggs*
    - **many / (a) few / several**: *many apples, a few carrots, several lemons*

Examples

- *I bought **a** sandwich and **two** salads.*
- *There aren't **many** seats left.*
- *We have **few** options today.* (more formal/negative tone)
- *We have **a few** options today.* (a small, but positive number)

⚠️ **Common mistake:** Don't use **much** with plural countables.
❌ *much tomatoes* → ✅ *many tomatoes*

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2) Uncountable nouns

- Mass/abstract substances you don't count individually: **rice, water, soup, tea, bread, information, advice, furniture**.
- Usually **no plural -s**.
- Determiners you can use:
    - **much / (a) little / a lot of / lots of**: *much water, a little salt, a lot of rice*
    - **some / any**: *some sugar, any juice*
    - **no**: *no milk*

Examples

- *There isn't **much** rice left.*
- *Add **a little** salt.*
- *We have **a lot of** bread.*

💡 To "count" uncountables, use **containers/units**:
a bottle of water, a cup of tea, a bowl of soup, a slice of bread, a piece of furniture, a piece of advice, a bit of information.

⚠️ **Common mistake:** Don't add -s.
❌ *informations, advices, furnitures* → ✅ *information, advice, furniture* (uncountable)

3) some vs. any (core rule)

- **some**:
  - **Affirmative statements**: *We have **some** olives.*
  - **Offers/requests**: *Would you like **some** tea?* / *Could I have **some** water?*
- **any**:
  - **Negatives**: *We don't have **any** fish.*
  - **Questions**: *Do you have **any** milk?*

With plurals & uncountables

- Plural countables: *some/any tomatoes*
- Uncountables: *some/any rice*

Special/advanced uses

- **any** in positive sentences = "it doesn't matter which/which one":
  - *You can choose **any** dessert.* (= all options are fine)
- **some** in questions is natural for **offers/requests** because we expect "Yes":
  - *Would you like **some** bread?* (friendly offer)
  - *Do you have **any** bread?* (neutral information question)
- **not … any** = **no**:
  - *We don't have **any** lemons. = We have **no** lemons.*

4) a/an — only with singular countables

- ✅ *a tomato, an onion, a sandwich*
- ❌ *a rice, an advice, a water* (unless you mean **a unit**: *a bowl of rice, a bottle of water, a piece of advice*)

a vs. **an**: use **an** before a vowel **sound** (*an apple, an egg, an hour*), **a** before a consonant sound (*a university* /ju:…/).

5) much / many / a lot of / lots of

- **many** → plural countables: *many apples, many ideas*
- **much** → uncountables: *much milk, much time*
- **a lot of / lots of** → both countable **and** uncountable (very common, informal-neutral):
  - *a lot of apples* / *a lot of water*

In everyday positive sentences, **a lot of** is more natural than **much/many**.
*We have **a lot of** tea.* (sounds more natural than *We have much tea.*)

6) (a) few vs. (a) little

- Countables: **few / a few**
  - *few* = not many (negative) → *We have **few** chairs.* (problematic)
  - *a few* = some (positive) → *We have **a few** chairs.* (enough for now)
- Uncountables: **little / a little**
  - *little* = not much (negative) → *There is **little** sugar.*
  - *a little* = some (positive) → *There is **a little** sugar.*

Exercise 1 – a/an, some, any

Complete the sentences.

1. I'd like ___ bowl of soup.
2. There aren't ___ lemons left.
3. Do we have ___ rice?
4. She bought ___ tomatoes for the salad.
5. Is there ___ orange juice in the fridge?

Exercise 2 – Countable vs. Uncountable (choose)

1. We need (some / any / a) **bread**.
2. Do you have (some / any) **eggs**?
3. There isn't (some / any) **milk**.
4. I ate (a / some) **banana**.
5. Are there (some / any) **olives** on the table?

Exercise 3 – Questions & short answers

Make a question with **any**, then give a natural short answer.
Model: sugar → *Is there any sugar?* → *Yes, there is.*
a) tomatoes → _____ → _____
b) water → _____ → _____
c) apples → _____ → _____
d) bread → _____ → _____

Exercise 4 – Fix the mistakes

Rewrite correctly (one error in each).

1. We don't need some onions.
2. Is there a milk in the bottle?
3. I'd like any tea, please.
4. There are much bananas in the basket.
5. Do you have some table for four?

D. Speaking

1) Food Preferences – Pair Work

- **A:** Ask about your partner's likes/dislikes using prompts: *spicy food, seafood, vegetables, desserts, hot drinks, breakfast foods*.
- **B:** Answer with reasons and frequency: *I love…, I don't really like…, I usually…, I never… because…*
- **Follow-up:** Compare eating habits: *We both like… / Unlike me, my partner…*

Support language:

- *What do you usually have for breakfast/lunch/dinner?*
- *How often do you eat…?* (always / often / sometimes / rarely / never)
- *In my opinion…*, *Personally, I prefer…*

2) Ordering in a Café – Role-Play

Mini-menu (for practice):

- **Drinks:** mint tea, coffee, orange juice, water
- **Snacks:** sardine sandwich, chicken panini, slice of cake, salad
- **Extras:** olives, fries

Roles:

- **Customer:** Greet, ask for a table, order drinks & snacks, ask about ingredients, request the bill.
- **Server:** Greet, offer options, answer questions, confirm order, suggest extras, bring the bill.

Useful phrases:

- Customer: *Could I have…? I'd like… Do you have any…? Can I get the bill, please?*
- Server: *Here's today's special… Would you like anything else? Still or sparkling? That comes to…*

Task: Perform once, switch roles, then add a special request (e.g., "no onions", "extra lemon").

E. Writing – Paragraph: My Eating Habits

Goal: 90–120 words.
Plan:

1. **Introduction:** how many meals a day; typical breakfast.
2. **Main:** usual lunch/dinner; snacks; drinks; where you eat (home/school/work/café).
3. **Habits & preferences:** healthy choices; foods you avoid; how often you eat out.
4. **Closing:** one change you want to make (e.g., less sugar, more vegetables).

Language tips: Use **some/any** and countable/uncountable correctly (e.g., *some fruit, any juice, a sandwich, many vegetables, much water*). Use time markers (*usually, often, on weekends*).

Answer Keys

Reading Keys

2. a. market b. sardine sandwiches c. sweet and savory
3. a. False b. True c. Not Given
4. a. chickpeas, lentils (any two) b. Invite neighbors to eat
5. a. roasted b. pastry (or "thin pastry") c. tea

Vocabulary Keys

B1 – Food groups (example answers):

- **Grains/Carbs:** bread, couscous, rice
- **Fruit/Vegetables:** oranges, tomatoes, onions
- **Protein/Dairy:** chicken, yogurt, sardines, almonds

B2 – Meal collocations: 1–b, 2–c, 3–a, 4–d

B3 – Restaurant phrases:

a. **Could I…** b. **I'd like…** c. **still or sparkling** d. **Anything else** e. **the bill**

Grammar Keys

Exercise 1: 1. a 2. any 3. any 4. some 5. any

Exercise 2: 1. some 2. any 3. any 4. a 5. any

Exercise 3 (sample):

a) *Are there any tomatoes? → Yes, there are.*

b) *Is there any water? → No, there isn't.* (answers may vary)

c) *Are there any apples? → Yes, there are.*

d) *Is there any bread? → No, there isn't.*

Exercise 4:

1. We don't need **any** onions.
2. Is there **any** milk in the bottle? / Is there **milk** in the bottle?
3. I'd like **some** tea, please.
4. There are **many** bananas in the basket. / **There are a lot of bananas**.
5. Do you have **a** table for four?